UNIT 12 · ADVANCED PEN + INK · TIER 3 · 8 POINTS

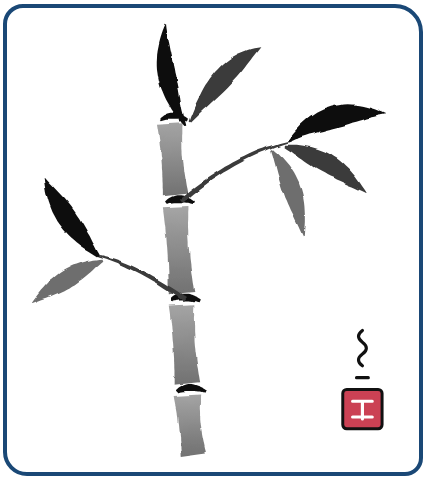
SUMI-E

(LESS IS MORE)

BRUSH + INK ONLY!

Sumi-e is Japanese ink painting. Masters like Sesshu trained for years to paint a whole stalk of bamboo in a handful of strokes. Your job: paint one subject with as **few strokes as possible**, so every stroke has to count.

01 WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE



Bamboo in 17 strokes

LOAD THE BRUSH

Dip in light ink, then just the tip in dark. Now one stroke goes dark to light.

ONE STROKE, ONE TRY

Never go back over a stroke. Leave a shaky one alone.

EMPTY SPACE COUNTS

White paper is part of the painting. In Japanese it's **ma**.

PAINT THE SPIRIT

Skip the details. Show how it bends and grows.

02 THE RULES

- **Brush and black ink only.** No pencil, pen or Sharpie on the final.
- **25 strokes max.** Count them as you paint.
- Leave at least **1/3 of the paper empty.**
- Subject: bamboo, orchid, plum blossom, chrysanthemum, or your own idea.
- **Sign it** and add a **red seal.**

Rehearse it. Sumi-e is a performance. Paint your whole design 3 times on scrap paper before you touch the final. The 4th time is the one that counts.

03 HOW TO WORK

1. **STUDY** — look up real sumi-e
2. **PRELIM** — drills + 3 thumbnails
3. **REHEARSE** — paint it 3 times on scrap
4. **PAINT** — the final. Count strokes!
5. **SEAL** — sign + red stamp

04 HOW IT'S GRADED

8 pts · 2 = yes · 1 = partly · 0 = missing

- ☐ 2 pts **Planning:** prelim done, 3 thumbnails, best one circled.
- ☐ 2 pts **Few strokes:** 25 or fewer, counted, none gone over twice.
- ☐ 2 pts **Brush control:** 3+ ink tones and dark-to-light loaded strokes.
- ☐ 2 pts **Composition:** 1/3 empty, subject reads clearly, signed + sealed.